

THE BLUE CARD CALENDAR



Assisting Holocaust
Survivors in Need



5783

THE BLUE CARD is a charitable organization that has been aiding Holocaust survivors since 1934. It is dedicated to the support of European Jewish survivors and their descendants in this country, who still suffer from the effects of Nazi persecution, are sick or emotionally unstable, have been unable to achieve economic independence, or have lost it through sickness or old age; in many cases the Holocaust deprived them of family. The Blue Card's activities aren't duplicated by any other Jewish welfare agencies. During the year 2021, The Blue Card distributed approximately \$2.0 million. This brings the grant total since The Blue Card's inception to nearly \$48 million.

THE BLUE CARD continues to receive a four star rating from Charity Navigator, a distinction awarded to only four percent of all charities. The Blue Card is Better Business Bureau (BBB) accredited.

THE BLUE CARD mirrors the social conscience of our community. We hope it will be important to you, and that you will remember it in your last will. Your contribution is fully tax deductible.

THE BLUE CARD has been publishing this calendar for its friends and friends-to-be for more than 50 years in order to remind them, throughout the year, that there is an organization which is always ready to render assistance to our neediest.

PLEASE SEE *the inside back cover of this calendar for more information about The Blue Card.*

A copy of the most recent financial report may be obtained from The Blue Card, Inc., 171 Madison Ave. Suite 1405, New York, NY 10016.

Front cover: *The memorial at Babi Yar in memory of the Jews who perished there.*

Back cover: *Orthodox Jews at Uman, Ukraine, during Jewish New Year celebrations.*

THE BLUE CARD CALENDAR

For 5783 (2022-2023 C.E.)

ITS THEME:

THE JEWS OF UKRAINE

Published by

THE BLUE CARD, Inc.[®]

Serving needy Jewish Holocaust survivors since 1934

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Assisting Holocaust
Survivors in Need

5783

INTRODUCTION

Ukraine has been very much in the news, and its long Jewish history merits a deeper look. Ukraine has been what the scholar Yohanan Petrovsky-Shtern calls a borderland. In his words, it “has been a colonial entity inhabited by peoples of highly heterogeneous political, economic, cultural, and religious loyalties and identities, very often in flux...”. Ukraine was never a properly functioning unitary entity until the 1991 collapse of the Soviet Union, and its different regions were at various times parts of different empires — most notably the Russian Empire and then the Soviet Union.

The ethnic identities of Ukraine’s inhabitants have varied according to geographic region, and in addition to ethnic Ukrainian have included Russian, Polish, Hungarian, German, Romanian and quite a few more. Today, ethnic Ukrainians and ethnic Russians form the vast majority of Ukraine’s population.

Jews have played a vital role in Ukraine’s history, as key contributors to its culture and economy, and also as targets of repression and at times murder, most especially the mass murder that was the Holocaust. At the beginning of the 20th century, Jews in present-day Ukraine numbered about 2.6 million, some 8.5% of a total population of just over 30 million — a very substantial minority. The Jewish population just prior to the Russian invasion of 2022 was most likely about 100,000, though a precise number is hard to estimate.

The first Jews to settle in Ukraine were maritime traders, some of them Greek-speaking, who arrived in the first centuries C.E. and established communities along the Black Sea, especially in Crimea. They traded in commodities from all over the known world and lived in communities where synagogues were the centers of religious and social life. These communities persisted for centuries and traded with peoples further north, many of whom were nomadic.

By the 10th century, there were Jewish communities in the region of Kyiv with populations that originated in Central Europe and in Khazaria to the east. But the largest source of Jewish migration to the region ultimately became Yiddish-speaking Ashkenazi Jews from Central Europe and Poland. By the 15th century they were the dominant Jewish population in Ukraine, and they remained so in the centuries that followed. Much of Ukraine was included in the region in the west of the Russian Empire, called the Pale of Settlement, where Jews were permitted to live beginning in 1791.

Many Jewish communities were able to flourish economically and culturally during the 17th, 18th and 19th centuries, but waves of antisemitism and attacks against Jews did great damage to lives and property, and in turn led to waves of emigration. The many pogroms — riots that killed and injured Jews and damaged their property — between the 1880s

and early 1920s were devastating. Although Jewish life became more stable during the early years after Ukraine became part of the Soviet Union in 1922, in time many Jewish tradespeople had their shops nationalized by the Soviets, and Jewish officials and intellectuals faced repression.

The German invasion of the Soviet Union in June 1941 brought the Holocaust to Ukraine. Though the Soviets were able to move some 3.8 million people, including 900,000 Jews, eastward to comparative safety, the Holocaust devastated Ukrainian Jewry. Within days of the invasion, the Germans had begun rounding up and shooting Jews. Other Jews were forced into ghettos, which were subsequently liquidated and their inhabitants sent to death camps or murdered. Babi Yar, described in this calendar, was only one of many mass murder sites. Mass killings began in the initial months of the German occupation and continued during the ensuing years, up until the Soviet Union's reconquest of Ukraine in 1943 and 1944.

All told, as many as 1.6 million Ukrainian Jews may have been murdered during the Holocaust.

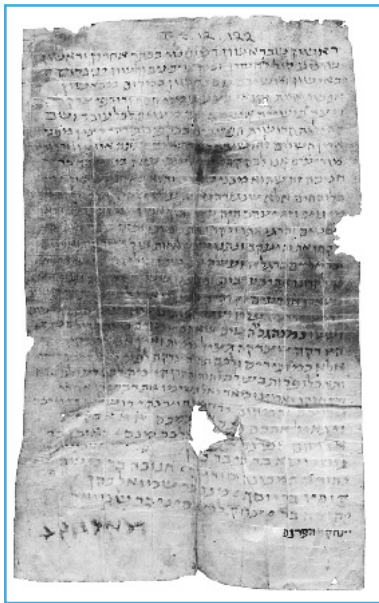
After the war, Jews were among those who returned to Ukraine from the eastern evacuation. The postwar years saw official antisemitism, along with repression and in some cases imprisonment for prominent Jews and secret executions. The situation improved, though, after Stalin's death in 1953, and by the 1980s there was a much-improved atmosphere of tolerance in Ukraine, even as considerable antisemitism persisted.

The years of Ukrainian independence have seen the paradox of the building of strong religious and cultural institutions along with extensive emigration, especially to Israel. And the Russian invasion of 2022 has seen a huge exodus of people of all persuasions from Ukraine. It remains to be seen how many of the Jews who left will return.

— Ralph Hammelbacher

Yohanan Petrovsky-Shtern is the leading writer on Ukrainian Jewish history and culture, and his works, notably the book *Jews and Ukrainians, A Millennium of Coexistence*, coauthored with Paul Robert Magocsi, have served as key sources for this calendar. Israel Bartel's *The Jews of Eastern Europe, 1772-1881* was also very helpful.

This year's edition was edited by Ralph Hammelbacher. Hella Hammelbacher created the original design, which was ably realized by Jacqueline Enrique.



The Kyivan letter.

Among the hundreds of thousands of documents found in Cairo's Ben Ezra Synagogue (a trove collectively known as the Cairo Geniza) is a letter, written in Hebrew on parchment, that dates to approximately 930 C.E. It is known as the Kyivan letter, and in it members of the Jewish community ask that assistance be given to Jacob, son of Hannukah, in repaying his debts. Jacob is described as being from a good family but obligated to repay money borrowed from gentiles by his brother, who had then been killed by brigands. Jacob, the letter goes on to say, was captured by his brother's creditors and put in irons for a year.

Aside from providing evidence of there being a well-established Jewish community in Kyiv with organized leadership in the 10th century, there are a number of other aspects to the letter that have inspired scholarly debate. Some think the letter may have been sent to Kyiv rather than from Kyiv. Some of the signatories have Slavic names, which may indicate family origins from elsewhere, or else may be evidence of assimilation. There continues to be controversy over the significance of the runes at the bottom of the letter.

Elul 5782 - Tishri 5783

SEPTEMBER 2022

SUNDAY

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

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Labor Day

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*Erev
Rosh Hashanah*

*Tishri 1 5783
Rosh Hashanah*

*Rosh Hashanah
Second Day*



The Jewish quarter of Uman during the second decade of the 20th century.

In the 1760s, a mix of peasants, serfs and impoverished townspeople began rebelling against economic and religious oppression. Forming bands of rebels known as *haidamakas*, they began raiding towns and the estates of overlords, looting and burning them.

The town of Uman, halfway between Kyiv and the Black Sea port of Odesa, was established in the 17th century. It had a substantial Jewish population. When the *haidamakas* came to Uman in June 1768, several

thousand Jews took refuge in the synagogue, where the *haidamakas* attacked with cannon fire. Though earlier estimates were much higher, it is now believed that some 3,000 Jews and Poles were killed.

The renowned Rabbi Nachman of Breslov moved to Uman in 1810, during the last year of his life. Uman to this day continues to be a place of pilgrimage for Jews to honor his memory; in past years, 30,000 Jews came there during Rosh Hashanah.

SUNDAY

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

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Erev
Yom Kippur

Yom Kippur

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Erev Succoth

Columbus Day
Succoth 1st Day

Succoth 2nd Day

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Hoshana Rabba

Shemini Atzeret

Simchat Torah

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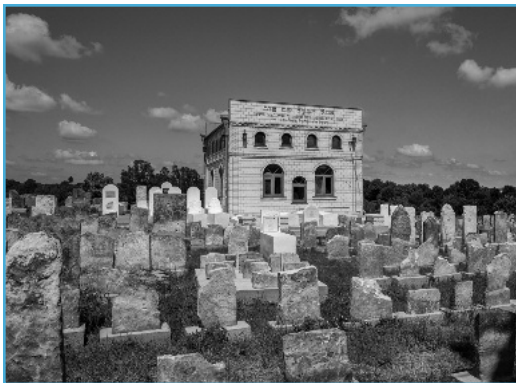
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Heshvan 1



Tomb of the Baal Shem Tov, Medzhybizh, Ukraine.

In the middle of the 18th century, western Ukraine became the cradle of Hasidic Judaism, spurred by the branch of Jewish mysticism called Kabbalah. The central belief of Hasidism is the immanence of God, i.e. God's pervasiveness in every aspect of the spiritual and material world. To be truly devoted is to access one's divine essence through contemplation and to understand the superficiality of corporeal existence.

With these beliefs came a set of practices that included ritual bathing, fasting, denial of the pleasures of the flesh, and a host of others.

The founder of Hasidism was Israel ben Eliezer, who lived between about 1698 and 1760. He is known as the Baal Shem Tov, which means "Master of the Good Name," and by the acronym Besht. He acquired legions of followers, and within a few decades Hasidism had spread widely, especially to the west and north.

Today, of course, there are large groups of Hasidim in many parts of the world, notably Israel and New York. Many speak Yiddish in addition to Hebrew, English and other languages.

SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
		1	2	3	4	5
6 <i>Daylight Saving Time Ends</i>	7	8 <i>U.S Election Day</i>	9 <i>Kristallnacht</i>	10	11 <i>Veterans Day</i>	12
13	14	15	16	17	18	19
20	21	22	23	24 <i>Thanksgiving</i>	25 <i>Kislev 1</i>	26
27	28	29	30			



The marketplace in Drohobych in the early 1900s.

During the 18th and 19th centuries, about two-thirds of Ukraine's Jews lived in *shtetls*. The shtetl was a Jewish subcommunity of a market town that was owned by a Polish Catholic magnate. In it, Jews were able to live and at times flourish, pursuing religious worship and study and prospering economically.

The writer Sholem Aleichem, who was born in Ukraine, wrote about shtetl life, and some his stories formed the basis for the Broadway musical *Fiddler on the Roof*. Contrary to their portrayal, though,

shtetls were vital communities during much of their history. The writer Yohanan Petrovsky-Shtern defines the golden age of the shtetl as running from the 1790s to the 1840s. During that time, Jews imported and sold commodities from far away. Many became artisans such as carpenters, tailors, shoemakers, blacksmiths and butchers. The shtetl was a hub of activity that Jews were proud to live in.

Of note is the role played by the Jewish-owned tavern. It was a place to unwind and let off steam, and also the locus of a profitable trade in liquor. When the Russian administration banned Jews from owning taverns in the 1830s, it caused tremendous economic hardship in the form of lost profits and unemployment.

Kislev - Tevet 5783

DECEMBER 2022

SUNDAY

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

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*Hanukkah
First Candle*

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Christmas Day

*Hanukkah
Eighth Candle*

Tevet 1

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New Year's Eve



An 1881 engraving from an English newspaper of an assault on a Jew in the presence of the military.

in Odessa in 1821, when Greeks rioted against the Jews, because Jews supposedly sympathized with the Ottomans in the killing of the Greek Patriarch of Constantinople.

The assassination of Tsar Alexander II in 1881 precipitated attacks on Jews in Ukraine. Several dozen are thought to have been killed in the pogrom, and the damage to Jewish property was extensive. Jews had no involvement in Alexander's killing, but widespread antisemitism found an outlet, despite Russian efforts to stop the violence.

The Russian word “pogrom” long ago entered the English language. The word means organized violence, typically in the form of a riot, directed against an ethnic group, particularly Jews, with the aim of murdering and often entirely eliminating that group. Pogroms were often directed against Jews of Ukraine and other Eastern European areas in the latter part of the 19th century and the 20th century.

The first recorded pogrom in what is now Ukraine took place

Tevet - Shevat 5783

JANUARY 2023

SUNDAY

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

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New Year's Day

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*Martin Luther
King Jr. Day*

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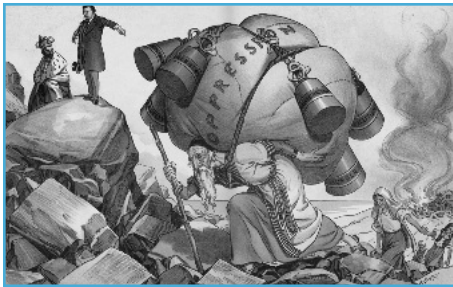
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Shevat 1

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A 1905 political cartoon from Judge Magazine: Theodore Roosevelt telling Tsar Nicholas II “Stop your cruel oppression of the Jews.”

Pogroms against the Jews continued during the 1880s and accelerated after the 1894 accession of Tsar Nicholas II, who used violence against Jews as an outlet for reducing revolutionary pressure against him. In 1905 alone, there were pogroms in some 500 Ukrainian towns in which about 1,000 Jews were killed, many more injured, and great damage done to Jewish property. The persecution led Ukrainian Jews to begin joining the wave of emigration that had already begun some years earlier in nearby regions. The scholar Zvi Gitelman estimates that “from 1881 to 1912, almost 1.9 million

Jews emigrated from the Russian Empire, 84 percent of them to the United States, 8.5 percent to England, 2.2 percent to Canada, and 2.1 percent to Palestine.”

The violence continued during World War I and the following years, including some 1,300 pogroms in 1919 alone, resulting in the murder of as many as 60,000 Jews and rendering about a million homeless.

After Ukraine’s 1922 incorporation into the Union of Soviet Socialist Republics and up until the German invasion, the situation of Jews in Ukraine improved somewhat, and the violence diminished. Many Jews moved from shtetls to cities. Under Stalin in the 1930s, though, Jewish intelligentsia and officials were purged from the party and a number sent to Siberia.

Shevat - Adar 5783

FEBRUARY 2023

SUNDAY

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

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Tu B'Shevat

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Valentine's Day

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Presidents' Day

Adar 1

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Babi Yar immediately after the initial mass killings, with German soldiers overseeing Soviet prisoners of war who were ordered to cover the remains of the murdered Jews.

Nazi Germany invaded the Soviet Union on June 22, 1941, in an enormous effort named Operation Barbarossa that involved more than 3 million German and Axis soldiers along a front that extended 1,800 miles. The Germans at first advanced swiftly, arriving in Kyiv on September 19, 1941. At that point there were some 60,000 Jewish residents remaining in Kyiv, with about 100,000 having left since the start of the invasion.

Using explosions caused by mines left by retreating Soviet soldiers as a pretext, the German command decided to exterminate Kyiv's Jewish population. On September 29 and 30, 1941, Jews were stripped of their clothing and possessions and marched to a ravine called Babyn Yar (often rendered in English as Babi Yar). There they were machine-gunned to death. According to German documents, 33,771 were murdered during those two days, their bodies covered over in a mass grave in the ravine.

Babi Yar continued to be used as a killing site by the Nazis, with a total now thought to be about 70,000 people — of whom some 45,000 were Jews — murdered there prior to the German retreat in 1943.

Adar - Nisan 5783

MARCH 2023

SUNDAY

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

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Erev Purim

Purim

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*Daylight Saving
Time Begins*

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Nisan 1

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Dina Pronicheva testifying during a war crimes trial in Kyiv.

There were few survivors at Babi Yar. One of them was Dina Pronicheva, whose testimony can be read on the Yad Vashem website. Before the Germans were able to shoot her, she fell into the ravine, likely out of fear, and lay motionless amid the bodies of dead and barely alive Jews. That night she was able to climb out and escape.

Before their 1943 retreat, the Germans attempted to conceal their atrocities at Babi Yar by exhuming and cremating the bodies, but word got out anyway; the killings were reported as early as late 1943. Many of the Germans responsible were tried after the war in Nuremberg, Kyiv and Darmstadt, with a number

receiving death sentences and others sentenced to prison terms.

In part because of Soviet suppression of Babi Yar's history, for many years there were no formal memorials to what had happened. The Russian poet Yevgeny Yevtushenko in 1961 wrote a poem, "Babi Yar," partly in protest; it begins "Over Babi Yar there are no memorials." The composer Dmitri Shostakovich's Symphony #13, subtitled "Babi Yar," uses the text of Yevtushenko's poem in its first movement. In 1991, a monument in the shape of a menorah was dedicated on the site, and there are plans for a museum. During the Russian invasion of Ukraine in 2022, the site was hit by a Russian missile and the building that was to be the museum was set on fire.

Nisan - Iyar 5783

APRIL 2023

SUNDAY

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

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*Erev Passover
(First Seder)*

*Passover 1st Day
(Second Seder)*

Good Friday

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Easter Sunday

Passover 8th Day

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Iyar 1

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*Israel
Independence
Day*



A woman's shoe, found in a cave in western Ukraine.

In 1993, following the breakup of the Soviet Union, Chris Nicola, a New York State investigator with a passion for caving, set out to explore western Ukraine's gypsum caves, known for being among the world's largest. In one of them he found a host of unexpected objects: women's shoes, wooden bed frames, buttons, earthen tables and chairs, medicine bottles and much more. Curious, he eventually uncovered the story of the Ukrainian Jews who hid underground for 511 days beginning in October 1942 — and survived.

When Jews began to be ordered to the ghetto in the town of Korolowka, in what is now western Ukraine, Esther Stermer realized that that was a death sentence. So she led her husband, children and grandchildren, along with several other Jews, to the Verteba cave. After German troops discovered them there and captured two who were never seen again, the rest, in mortal danger, moved to the Priest's Grotto cave after hiding on a farm. There, a total of 38 people from 5 families lived in near-complete darkness, lighting candles only to cook. The men ventured out at night to procure food. On one occasion they survived villagers' covering over the cave entrance and on another, they survived an attempt to ambush them. The families survived with the bare minimum of food.

All 38 survived the war, with many emigrating to the United States and Canada afterwards. The story is recounted in the 2013 film *No Place on Earth*.

Iyar - Sivan 5783

MAY 2023

SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
	1	2	3	4	5	6
7	8	9 <i>Lag B'Omer</i>	10	11	12	13
14 <i>Mother's Day</i>	15	16	17	18	19	20
21 <i>Sivan 1</i>	22	23	24	25 <i>Erev Shavuot</i>	26 <i>Shavuot 1st Day</i>	27 <i>Shavuot 2nd Day</i>
28	29 <i>Memorial Day</i>	30	31			



Golda Meir.

Golda Meir was born Golda Mabovitch in Kyiv in 1898. Her family emigrated to the United States in 1906 to escape the pogroms; her father had gone to New York in 1903 and then to Wisconsin in search of work to support his family. One of her earliest memories was seeing her father fortify their house in Kyiv in preparation for an expected pogrom. Meir was later quoted as saying “The Russia I knew was a place that men on horses butchered Jews.”

She became an ardent Zionist, and in 1917 married Morris Meyerson, a socialist. They were able to emigrate to Palestine in 1921, initially settling on a kibbutz. With her drive to be involved in causes of importance, Meir rose through the ranks of Histadrut, the Israeli labor federation, and took on more general political roles, becoming the lead Zionist negotiator with the British government. She was one of 24 signers of Israel’s Declaration of Independence in 1948.

After stints as Labor Minister and Foreign Minister, she retired from the Israeli government because of ill health. After recovering from lymphoma, she was called out of retirement to become prime minister in 1969. She presided over Israel’s participation in the 1973 Yom Kippur War, and in the aftermath faced criticism over Israel’s insufficient preparation. Unable to form a new government, she resigned in 1974. She died in 1978.

Today, she is warmly remembered for the bridges she built with other countries, for her dedication to Israel’s interests and for her efforts to promote social justice.

Sivan - Tammuz 5783

JUNE 2023

SUNDAY

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

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Father's Day

Juneteenth

Tammuz 1

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Nudie Cohn wearing a “Nudie suit,” with one of the 18 custom cars he created.

On the lighter side is the story of Nuta Kotlyarenko, who was born to a Jewish family in Kyiv in 1902. When he was 11, his parents sent him to the United States with his brother to escape the pogroms. He acquired the nickname “Nudie” and adopted the name Nudie Cohn. He learned to be a tailor in New York, then crossed the US, working as a shoeshine boy and a boxer. Stopping in Mankato, Minnesota, he met the woman he married, Bobbie Kruger; they would stay married the rest of their lives.

Returning to New York, Nudie opened a shop that specialized in G-strings for burlesque performers, covering the garments with something that became one of his trademarks: rhinestones. After New York outlawed burlesque, the Cohns moved to California, eventually opening their own store in Hollywood. Nudie’s first famous client was the musician Tex Williams, followed by the country singer-songwriter Lefty Frizzell. “Nudie suits” remain instantly recognizable today for their extravagant designs, bright colors, intricate embroidery and of course rhinestones. By the 1970s, his customers included Porter Wagoner (who owned 52 suits), Roy Rogers and Dale Evans, George Jones and Elvis Presley, who famously wore a gold lamé Nudie suit on the cover of *50,000,000 Elvis Fans Can't Be Wrong*. That suit is now on display at Graceland.

Nudie Cohn died at the age of 81 in 1984, but his clothing and influence live on.

SUNDAY

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

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*Independence
Day*

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Av 1

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Tisha B'Av



At a klezmer music festival in Kyiv, 2019.

probably about 100,000 Jews in Ukraine.

Notwithstanding the population decline, the years following independence saw a strong revival of Jewish religion and culture. There was a tremendous increase in religious education, with religious leaders arriving from all over the world to help Jewish Ukrainians begin the process. And notable among the arts was a resurgence in the performance of klezmer music, a vibrant form of music typically performed at weddings and celebrations, for which Ukraine was one of the heartlands in the 18th, 19th and 20th centuries.

In the period prior to World War II, Ukraine had a Jewish population of about 2.5 million, comprising some 15% of the total population. Estimates of subsequent Jewish numbers vary widely, in part because during the Soviet era many Jewish Ukrainians hid their Jewish identity, but a 1989 census tallied a Jewish of population of 489,000. In the years since, there has been a significant decline because of intermarriage and emigration, particularly to Israel. At the onset of the Russian invasion, there were

Av - Elul 5783

AUGUST 2023

SUNDAY

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

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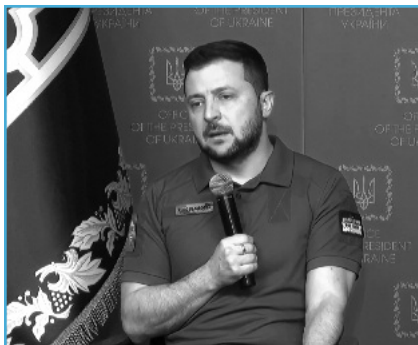
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Elul 1



Volodymyr Zelenskyy during a press conference in 2022.

Volodymyr Zelenskyy, born in 1978 in the city of Kryvyi Rih, is the current president of Ukraine, elected in 2019 with 73% of the vote. Both his parents are Jewish. Zelenskyy has said that his paternal great-grandfather and his wife were killed when their house was burned during a German massacre, and his grandfather's three brothers were murdered by German occupation forces during the Holocaust.

Zelenskyy's upbringing was secular; he was raised in a Russian-speaking home when Ukraine was part of the Soviet Union. The Soviets repressed virtually all religions, Judaism in particular, so Zelenskyy's experience was typical.

Though he obtained a law degree in Ukraine, Zelenskyy ended up joining an improvisational comedy troupe, becoming universally known and starring in television roles — including one series in which he plays the role of a teacher elected president of Ukraine after a video rant about government corruption. In a case of life imitating art, Zelenskyy was subsequently elected president on a platform of fighting corruption.

Zelenskyy has won enormous renown and admiration for his steadfastness in fighting the Russian invasion of Ukraine, and for his role in mobilizing assistance from the United States, European Union and other friendly countries.

Elul 5783 - Tishri 5784

SEPTEMBER 2023

SUNDAY

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

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Labor Day

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*Erev
Rosh Hashanah*

*Tishri 1 5784
Rosh Hashanah*

17

*Rosh Hashanah
Second Day*

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23

24

*Erev
Yom Kippur*

25

Yom Kippur

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Erev Succoth

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Succoth 1st Day

Many thousands of Americans of Ukrainian Jewish descent have made notable contributions to every facet of human endeavor. Here are a very few of them:



Leonard Bernstein.

- Herb Alpert, trumpeter, composer and executive
- Leonard Bernstein, composer and conductor
- Antony Blinken, US Secretary of State
- Harold Bloom, literary critic
- Mel Brooks and Sid Caesar, comedians
- Noam Chomsky, linguist and writer
- Bob Dylan, singer-songwriter
- Ruth Bader Ginsburg, Supreme Court justice
- Dustin Hoffman, actor
- Vladimir Horowitz, pianist
- Calvin Klein, fashion designer
- Lee Krasner, painter
- Paul Krugman, economist
- Mila Kunis, actor
- Abraham Maslow, psychologist
- Louise Nevelson, sculptor
- Judith Resnick, astronaut
- Regina Resnick, opera singer
- Menachim Schneerson, rabbi and religious leader
- Beverly Sills, opera singer and executive
- Charles Schumer, US senator
- Steve Spielberg, director
- Isaac Stern, violinist
- Sophie Tucker, entertainer

Tishri - Heshvan 5784

OCTOBER 2023

SUNDAY

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

1

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Succoth 2nd Day

Hoshana Rabba

Shemini Atzeret

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Columbus Day

*Indigenous
Peoples' Day*

Simchat Torah

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Heshvan 1

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Established in Germany in 1934, The Blue Card's sole purpose was to provide financial assistance to Jews fleeing from that country's growing persecution. It was re-established in the United States in 1939, to continue aiding refugees escaping from the Nazi horror. Today, it is the only organization in the United States whose sole mission is to aid needy Holocaust survivors by providing cash assistance. The Blue Card offers its invaluable help to Holocaust survivors through a variety of vital programs.

Description of The Blue Card's Programs

1. Claims Conference Emergency Cash Assistance Program: One-time grant assistance for emergency needs including:

- Housing and related costs such as late payments to prevent eviction or homelessness or shut off of utilities.

- Emergency relocation.
- Food purchases.
- Medical and dental care, including medical equipment not otherwise covered by insurance.
- Essential clothing and footwear.
- Purchase and repair of essential major and minor appliances.

2. Emergency Prevention Programs:

- Monthly Stipend – supports the most poverty-stricken survivors with monthly checks.
- Telephone Emergency Response System – provides the system to Holocaust survivors who do not have the financial resources to pay for installation, service and maintenance.

3. Health and Well-being Programs:

- Sigi B. Wilzig Fighting Cancer Together – offers aid to survivors battling cancer. Assistance is available for transportation to appointments, medical co-pays, nutrition and emotional support.
- Vitamins – provides survivors with multivitamins, minerals and supplements, as well as liquid meals.
- Jewish Holiday – provides financial support for the High Holidays, Hanukkah and for Passover, giving survivors the financial means to have a happier holiday season.
- Mazel Tov Birthday – provides survivors with a card and a check on their birthday. Receiving these mean a great deal to survivors who lost their entire families during the war.
- Adolph and Lotte Rosenberg Summer Vacation – survivors are provided with handicapped-accessible accommodations, transportation, scheduled meals, and a well-planned itinerary, making the program structured, safe, and group oriented.
- Sonia and Max Lonstein Bring a Smile – provides addition support to terminally ill Holocaust survivors. The program essentially grants survivors their final wish.

4. Educational and Outreach Programs:

- Nutrition Guidance - Educates survivors on proper nutrition.
- The Blue Card-Lissner Hospital Visitation Program – offers volunteer visits to hospitalized Holocaust survivors who need guidance and emotional support.

5. The Blue Card - Tech Friendly Aging Programs:

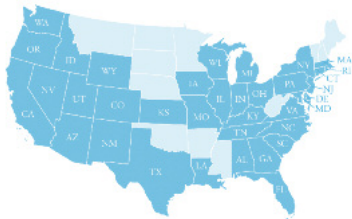
- **LIFWARE Utensils** – Lifware is an electronic stabilizing handle and a selection of attachments that include a soup spoon, everyday spoon, fork, and spork. Lifware Steady is designed to help people with hand tremor, which may be related to Parkinson's disease or essential tremor, eat more easily. Holocaust survivors suffering with Parkinson's Disease and other debilitating illnesses benefit tremendously from this special stabilizing unit.
- **Mood Restore Light Box** – Intelligent Light Therapy - A special, compact, and portable UV-free unit provides much needed light therapy to Holocaust survivors. In addition to effectively treating Season Affective Disorders (SAD), the Mood Restore Light Box, improves visual clarity and color rendering, as well as offsets seasonal weather and climate changes, and

helps support circadian rhythm regulation. This light box works wonders for thousands of our lonely survivors, especially those who are shut-ins and are home-bound during the colder winter days.

- **Robotic Companion Pets** – Companion pets bring comfort and happiness to the older population with interactive, cats and dogs that replicate the look, sounds and feel of real pets. Many studies have found that these pets have the ability to enhance one's well-being and quality of life through companionship.
- **FreeStyle Libre Glucose Monitoring Program** – The Freestyle Libre 2 system continuously measures glucose data with customizable, optional real time alarms. The unit gives people with diabetes excellent accuracy and actionable information to better manage their condition.

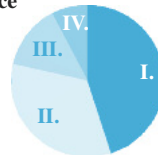
I. Ongoing Cash Assistance to Prevent Emergencies:	\$893,072.18
II. Emergency Cash Assistance Program:	\$683,417.79
III. Telephone Emergency Response Program:	\$249,480.01
IV. COVID-19 Assistance:	\$156,011.53
Total Unaudited 2021 Assistance:	\$1,981,981.51

The Blue Card's Clients Across the United States



The Blue Card - Grants at a Glance

In 2021, The Blue Card distributed almost \$2 million to destitute Holocaust survivors in the United States; above is the breakdown of that number.





Assisting Holocaust
Survivors in Need

THE BLUE CARD CALENDAR

5783

